

Literature • Fantasy

Grade	1	Word Count	170
Lexile	380L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level G		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

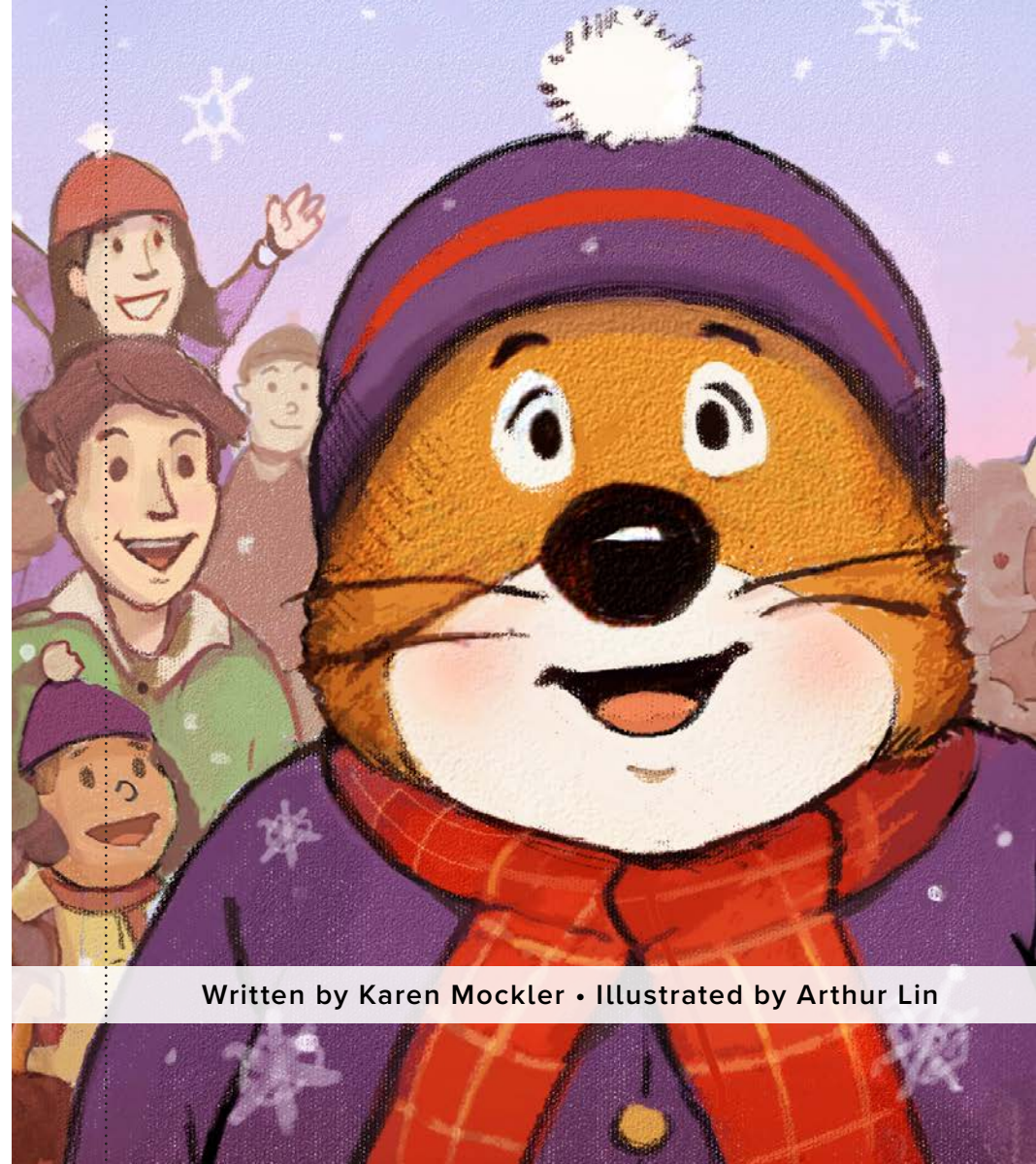
This fantasy shares the story of Groundhog Day from the groundhog's perspective. Gus the groundhog can't remember the last time he saw his shadow, and he is getting worried. Will Gus find his shadow outside, or will he find something far more interesting than that?



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Groundhog Goes Outside



Written by Karen Mockler • Illustrated by Arthur Lin

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Focus Question
How do Gus's feelings change
throughout the book?





It was the deep of winter.
Gus was worried.
He couldn't find his shadow
anywhere.



“Have you seen my shadow?”
Gus asked Dad.
“When did you see it last?”
Dad asked.



“Have you seen my shadow?”
Gus asked Mom.
“Go back, step by step,
until you find it,” Mom said.



“Have you seen my shadow?”
Gus asked Grace.
“Try looking where you
left it,” Grace said.



Gus stopped looking.
He began to shout:
“HAS ANYBODY SEEN
MY SHADOW?”



“Have you tried looking outside?”
asked Dad.
Gus hadn’t been outside
in months.
He hadn’t seen his shadow
in months.
Maybe his shadow was outside!



Gus left the burrow and went outside.

As soon as he did, someone began to cheer.

Children waved and jumped up and down.

People shot photos of him.

They all looked really happy.



Gus forgot about his shadow.
Gus was a star!



Back in the burrow, his family gathered around him. Gus grinned from ear to ear. “Did you find it?” asked Mom.



“Find what?” asked Gus.